Vocabulario · B1 a C1

125 phrasal verbs que vas a oír

Los phrasal verbs más útiles del inglés del día a día, en orden alfabético, con su significado y una frase de ejemplo.

Un phrasal verb es un verbo con una partícula (*up, out, off, on…*) que juntos significan algo distinto. Los nativos los usan constantemente al hablar, mucho más que el verbo "formal" equivalente: decimos **find out** antes que *discover* y **put off** antes que *postpone*. Por eso, si los entiendes, entiendes muchísimo más de las conversaciones reales.

> **Cómo usar esta lista:** no intentes aprenderlos todos. Marca cinco que te suenen de series o canciones, escribe una frase tuya con cada uno y úsalos esta semana cuando hables. Cuando ya te salgan sin pensar, marca otros cinco.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
add up	make sense, seem believable	Her story didn't add up.
back up	support someone	I'll back you up in the meeting.
blow up	explode	The car blew up after the accident.
break down	stop working (a car, a machine)	My car broke down on the motorway.
break in	enter a building by force	Someone broke in last night.
break out	start suddenly (a fire, a war); escape	A fire broke out in the building.
break up	end a relationship	They broke up after five years.
bring about	cause something to happen	The new policy brought about big changes.
bring up (1)	mention a topic	She brought up an interesting point in the meeting.
bring up (2)	raise a child	They brought up their children in the countryside.
call back	return a phone call	I'll call you back later.
call in	ask someone to come and help	They called in a specialist to fix the problem.
call off	cancel	They called off the meeting.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
call on	ask someone to speak	The teacher called on me to answer the question.
calm down	relax after being angry or nervous	She needed to calm down before talking.
carry on	continue	He carried on despite the difficulties.
carry out	do or complete a task	They carried out the plan successfully.
catch on	understand; become popular	It took me a while, but I finally caught on.
catch up	reach the same level as others	She needed to catch up on her work.
check in	register at a hotel or airport	We checked in at the hotel around noon.
check out	leave a hotel; look at something	They checked out early this morning.
cheer up	make someone feel happier	The joke cheered her up.
clean up	make a place tidy	Let's clean up before the guests arrive.
come across	find something by chance	I came across some old photos in the loft.
come along	go somewhere with someone	Would you like to come along with us?
come back	return	She came back after two weeks abroad.
come down with	start to have an illness	I think I'm coming down with a cold.
come out	be published; become known	The new book came out last week.
come over	visit someone's home	Why don't you come over later?
come up	be mentioned; happen unexpectedly	The issue came up in the meeting.
come up with	think of an idea or solution	She came up with a brilliant plan.
count on	rely on someone	You can count on me.
cut back (on)	reduce the amount of something	I need to cut back on spending.
cut down (on)	do or use less of something	I'm trying to cut down on sugar.
cut off	stop the supply of something	The company cut off their water.
deal with	handle a problem or situation	He's good at dealing with difficult clients.
do up	fasten (a coat, buttons); renovate	He did up his coat before going out.
do without	manage without something	We can do without sugar in our coffee.
dress up	wear smart clothes or a costume	She dressed up for the party.
drop by	visit briefly, without planning	I'll drop by your office later.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
drop off	take someone or something to a place and leave them	I'll drop you off at the station.
drop out	leave school, a course or a competition	He dropped out of university last year.
end up	finally be in a situation you didn't plan	We ended up staying longer than planned.
face up to	accept a difficult situation	It's time to face up to the truth.
fall apart	break into pieces	The chair fell apart when I sat on it.
fall behind	not keep up with others	She fell behind in her studies.
fall for	be tricked by; fall in love with	I fell for his lies. / She fell for him instantly.
figure out	understand or solve	I finally figured out the answer.
fill in (UK) / fill out (US)	complete a form	Please fill in this application.
find out	discover information	I found out the truth yesterday.
get along (with)	have a good relationship	They get along really well.
get away	escape	The thief managed to get away.
get away with	do something wrong and not be punished	He got away with cheating in the test.
get back	return	When will you get back from your trip?
get by	manage with what you have	We're getting by on a small income.
get down	make someone feel sad	The bad news really got me down.
get over	recover from something	It took her months to get over the break-up.
get together	meet socially	We should get together this weekend.
give away	give something for free	They gave away free samples at the event.
give in	stop resisting, accept defeat	He finally gave in to the pressure.
give out	hand something to several people	They gave out flyers at the event.
give up	stop trying; stop a habit	Don't give up on your dreams.
go ahead	start or continue with something	You can go ahead with your plan.
go on	continue; happen	The show must go on.
go out	leave home to do something social	They often go out on Friday nights.
go over	review or check	Let's go over the details one more time.
grow up	become an adult	She grew up in a small town.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
hand in	give work to a teacher or boss	Please hand in your homework on time.
hang out	spend free time with friends	I like to hang out with my friends at weekends.
hang up	end a phone call	He hung up before I could say goodbye.
hold back	stop yourself showing a feeling	He held back his anger during the meeting.
hold on	wait a moment	Hold on, I'll be right back.
keep on	continue doing something	He kept on talking despite the interruptions.
keep up	continue at the same level or speed	You're doing great, keep it up!
kick in	start to have an effect	The painkillers will kick in soon.
kick off	start (an event, a match)	The event will kick off at 10 am.
lay off	dismiss workers because there isn't enough work	They had to lay off several workers.
let down	disappoint someone	She felt let down by her friend.
let off	not punish someone	The teacher let him off with a warning.
look after	take care of	She looks after her younger brother.
look down on	think you are better than someone	She looks down on people who disagree with her.
look forward to	feel happy about something in the future	I'm looking forward to our holiday.
look into	investigate	They will look into the problem tomorrow.
look out	be careful	Look out! There's a car coming.
look up	search for information	She looked up the word in the dictionary.
make out	see, hear or understand with difficulty	I couldn't make out what he was saying.
make up	invent a story or excuse	He made up an excuse for being late.
make up (with)	become friends again after an argument	They finally made up after the fight.
make up for	compensate for something	He worked hard to make up for lost time.
pass away	die (polite)	His grandfather passed away last year.
pass out	faint	She passed out from exhaustion.
pay off	bring a good result	All your hard work will pay off.
pick on	treat someone badly again and again	He was always picked on at school.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
pick up	lift; collect someone or something	Can you pick up the kids from school?
point out	show or mention something	He pointed out the mistake in the document.
put down	criticise someone	Stop putting yourself down.
put off	postpone	They put off the meeting until next week.
put on	start wearing clothes	She put on her coat before going out.
put up	let someone stay in your home	We can put you up for the night.
put up with	tolerate	I can't put up with his behaviour any more.
run into	meet someone by chance	I ran into an old friend at the supermarket.
run out (of)	have none left	We've run out of milk.
run over	hit someone with a vehicle	He was nearly run over by a car.
see off	go with someone to say goodbye when they leave	We went to the airport to see them off.
set off	start a journey; make an alarm go off	We set off early. / The smoke set off the fire alarm.
set up	organise or prepare something	They set up the room for the party.
show off	try to impress people	He's always showing off his new gadgets.
show up	arrive, appear	She didn't show up for the meeting.
shut down	close (a business, a computer)	The company shut down the factory.
slow down	go more slowly	The car slowed down at the junction.
speak up	speak more loudly; give your opinion	Please speak up, I can't hear you.
stand out	be easy to notice	Her bright dress made her stand out.
take after	look or behave like a family member	She takes after her mother.
take off	leave the ground; become successful quickly	The plane took off on time. / The product really took off.
take out	remove; take outside	He took out the rubbish before leaving.
take over	take control of something	She took over the project after he left.
throw away	put in the bin	Don't throw away that bottle, recycle it.
turn down	refuse an offer; lower the volume	She turned down the job offer.
turn off	stop a machine or light	Turn off the lights when you leave.
turn on	start a machine or light	He turned on the TV to watch the news.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
turn up	arrive, often unexpectedly; increase the volume	He turned up at the party without warning.
wake up	stop sleeping	I woke up early this morning.
warm up	prepare your body for exercise	The players warmed up before the match.
work out	do exercise; find a solution	She works out every day. / We need to work out the problem.
write down	write something on paper	Please write down your phone number.

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